

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, Consumer Trading.*

Positioning, ten years owning regulated financial and data products, with hands-on crypto and DeFi depth, real AI prototyping practice, and the delivery discipline to ship at Kraken's pace.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY KRAKEN

Kraken's Consumer Trading team is doing something genuinely interesting: collapsing the boundary between stocks, crypto, and cash into a single, instant-conversion product surface. That is a hard UX and infrastructure problem, not just a distribution one, and it sits at the intersection of regulated finance and open-market mechanics where I have spent the last decade. The explicit expectation that PMs prototype with Claude Code and Cursor before writing specs matches how I already work: I built the construct8 marketplace funnel and the Qcrypt product architecture the same way. *That is the kind of team where the prototype and the spec reinforce each other instead of racing.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo prototyping and spec generation
- **Cursor / VSCode**, code-assisted product discovery
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototype validation
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day development support
- **Framer**, design-heavy interaction mockups
- **GPT**, research, edge-case generation, user story drafts
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder deck and roadmap communication

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, Kafka, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, SQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built solo from zero to one.

- Anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, removing onboarding friction.
 - LLM agents across the hiring funnel so a single operator runs the day-to-day.
 - Demonstrates the same zero-to-one, AI-native build approach Kraken's Consumer team expects PMs to apply when prototyping new trading features.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT KRAKEN

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with traders, support, and data to understand where the instant buy-sell-convert flow breaks or leaks users, and map the existing analytics instrumentation so I know what questions the current data can and cannot answer.

WEEK 2

Prototype, then specify.

Pick the highest-conviction gap from week one and build a Lovable or Claude Code prototype to test the idea before writing a single detailed spec, keeping validation cheap and reversible.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, close loops.

Run UAT on the first initiative alongside engineering, instrument the experiment, and open the stakeholder loop so Finance, Ops, and the roadmap stay synchronised as new signals come in.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at Kraken,

I am writing to apply for the Senior Product Manager, Consumer role. I have spent more than ten years owning product in regulated financial environments, payments at Kvitt (acquired into the girocard ecosystem), insurance infrastructure at Emil Group, and AI data platforms at Rohde & Schwarz for the FCAS programme, and I have been a hands-on crypto user and builder for eight years. Kraken's consumer product, which lets users instantly buy, sell, and convert any combination of stocks, cryptocurrencies, and cash, is the kind of full-stack trading challenge I want to own next.

The posting asks for comfort prototyping with Claude Code and Cursor before writing specs. This is already how I work. When I built construct8, a two-sided construction staffing marketplace, I used Claude Code to generate the funnel logic, Lovable to validate the UX before writing a single story, and SQL for funnel and churn analysis throughout. At Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing UI workflows for an internal AI platform and let the usage data, zero clicks on the beautiful UI-led design, redirect the roadmap, increasing pipeline runs by 200%. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safer; that principle is the same whether the product is a defence data pipeline or a retail trading interface.

My crypto and DeFi experience goes beyond a trading account. I actively trade perpetual futures and spot across Hyperliquid, Bitget, Jupiter, and 1inch, work with liquidation heatmaps on Coinglass and Hyblock Capital, and have spent significant time analyzing slippage, price impact, and routing mechanics. I build my own backtest engine and trading automation, and I understand the infrastructure layer, stablecoins, custody, exchange connectivity, cross-chain bridging, that makes digital asset markets function at scale. That combination of user-level depth and systems thinking maps directly to Consumer Trading's product suite.

On the delivery side, I have run cross-functional teams of fifteen or more through Scrum under hard constraints. At CLINET I cut a bloated roadmap to the top ten percent of features against agreed success measures and raised user acceptance fivefold. At EMIL Group I restructured an eighteen-person organisation into three lean teams and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production. I bring the same discipline to stakeholder alignment, UAT ownership, and data-driven prioritisation that the posting describes as core expectations.

Kraken's stated goal of advancing an open, global financial system is not a tagline I am repeating back: it is the reason I have stayed close to this space through multiple market cycles. I would be glad to discuss how my background maps to the specific initiatives Consumer Trading is running.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with thirteen years of product ownership in regulated industries, fintech, insurance, defence AI, public-sector analytics, and healthcare, and eight years of hands-on crypto and DeFi experience. I turn strategy, user needs, and technical constraints into a prioritised roadmap and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. I prototype with AI tools before writing specs, instrument competing workflows to let data redirect strategy, and take ownership from discovery through UAT to production.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Consumer and retail trading: spot trading, perpetual futures, DEX aggregation, cross-chain bridging, price impact and slippage analysis, liquidation heatmaps, backtesting, trading automation, CEX/DEX mechanics, stablecoins, custody.

AI-native product execution: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, Framer, GPT, Gamma.app; prototyping before speccing, LLM agent design, agentic workflow automation (n8n), prompt engineering, evaluation loops, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI).

Product management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support, UAT (user acceptance testing).

Product ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Analytics and data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, SQL, PostgreSQL, Dagster, dbt, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL.

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning, GitOps rollout and rollback with ArgoCD, CI/CD, test automation, regression gating.

Stakeholder and leadership: cross-functional team leadership (15+ engineers), C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management, Deputy IT Security Officer, GDPR.

Technical environments: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), REST APIs, MongoDB, Kafka, Git.

Payments and fintech: P2P mobile payments, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, POS and forecourt systems, payment flow and edge-case handling.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme across a 15+ person cross-functional team; GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes; data-instrumented workflow analysis increased pipeline runs by 200%.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

National labour-market analytics platform; introduced Dagster and dbt to cut data-update time by 75%; migrated bare-metal to containers; carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration concurrently. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023-2023

Cut a bloated roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Integrated CGM/KIS interface, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022-2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; reduced engineer attrition from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a SAFe matrix organisation with agile release trains and PI planning. POS and forecourt systems.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA 2021-2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace with anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the hiring funnel. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Hardware-software product for quantum-resistant encryption (OTP/true-RNG) that installs in under two minutes; enterprise sales cycle. Later Chair of the board.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Mobile group-based P2P payments built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · TALENTMATE

→